

PERSONAL PROFILE

Payments Domain and Subject Matter Expert with 9 years of experience in **client-facing, techno-functional project management** across Card and Cross-Border Payments. Specialized in project implementations, stakeholder coordination, and enterprise client delivery. Driven to deepen expertise in large-scale implementations while contributing to organizational growth through disciplined execution, collaboration, and continuous improvement.

Lean | Agile-Scrum | Six Sigma Green belt | Six Sigma Black belt | MS Project | Jira | ISO 8583,ISO 20022

ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Consistently delivered Project on time**, demonstrating strong execution discipline and delivery excellence (2022-24).
- Managed complex transfer-conversion projects at Mastercard (2023), ensuring **seamless customer migrations with no impact to live operations** (2023).
- **Recognized for impeccable support on PSD2 and Tokenization initiatives**, contributing to regulatory compliance and enhanced customer experience (2022).
- **Awarded Thredd Allrounder (2022), Thredd Star (2022), and Thredd Jira Hero (2019)** for excellence in card payments domain expertise, client support, and issue resolution, and also got recognized for delivery excellence, collaboration, and customer impact (2020).
- Winner of the **Trade Improvement Campaign at Yes Bank**, recognized for process improvement and operational efficiency initiatives (2017).

WORK EXPERIENCE

Team Lead - Payments

TerraPay | May 2024 - Present

- Working for Fintech's Customer Success team, **lead end-to-end delivery of products & services offered to TerraPay customers**, managed overall business & account management for the customer supporting **Pre-sales, Integration phase & post sales**.
- Supported customers from **Project initiation to operation handover** ensuring **customer's success** with the services offered conducting weekly calls, mitigating and managing escalations, resolving customer issues. If needed I ensured of initiation, tracking, managing and closing **CRs**.
- **Owned client facing project delivery managing project scoping, planning, timelines, and delivery governance**, enabling clear, action-oriented communication across customers and internal teams.
- Ensured technical readiness, commercial alignment, due diligence, security readiness, contracting, sandbox testing, pilots at customer end. **Orchestrate cross-functional delivery across Compliance, Legal, Engineering, QA, and Operations**, ensuring regulatory adherence and delivery milestones.
- **Spearheaded end-to-end TerraPay customer onboarding and integration lifecycle**, driving technical solutioning, API integrations, and go-live. Developed and maintained relationships at various level within customer origination ensuring quick outcome, faster resolution, project delivery and customer success.
- **Act as the Card Payments Domain SME**, providing strategic guidance in the projects, identifying critical defaults to enhance card processing and scalability.
- **Establish and evolve project governance frameworks**, owning project charters, MOMs, RAID logs, and milestone tracking to ensure alignment with objectives, risks, and success metrics. Acted as the primary client escalation point, maintaining CSAT scores above 95% across complex implementations
- **Represent programs in executive forums**, delivering clear status updates to CXOs, proactively managing expectations, and driving informed decision-making
- Leading an **AI-driven knowledge initiative** to develop an LLM-based solution that **automatically generates fact sheets**, consolidating regulatory requirements, transaction parameters, limits, and country-specific restrictions to streamline implementation, compliance readiness enhancing **transaction success**.

Senior Specialist, Implementations (Contractual role)

Mastercard | July 2022 - May2024

- Worked for MasterCard's Customer Implementation Service Team, **Led client implementations** for banks and financial organizations delivering Processor Conversions, Card migration, Portfolio conversion projects. I also handled projects across **Issuing, Acquiring, and Payment Gateway platforms** products.
- **Owned the full implementation lifecycle** from project kick-off to production go-live, consistently delivering 100% on-time implementations of all projects assigned while delivering 20+ projects.
- Applied strong **project management** practices to drive structured, **customer-centric project execution**; proactively managed risks and complex interdependencies, maintained **MOMs** and **RAID logs**, and defined mitigation strategies to **ensure seamless delivery** with minimal client impact.
- Gained deep understanding of Card Payments lifecycle; **Authorization, Clearing, settlement, Chargeback, Tokenization** and PCI-DSS (functional knowledge). While I also acquired Theoretical, functional and working knowledge in **Dual & single messaging systems** and along with **transaction processing rules**.
- **Acted as the primary client-facing implementation lead**, ensuring clear communication, stakeholder alignment, and responsible to maintain coordination between **Issuing bank, Card processors** and Internal teams for the project success. Showcased exceptional **negotiation** and **risk mitigation** skills.
- **Developed and executed detailed implementation plans**, owning scope, timelines, dependencies, and resource alignment across internal and client teams.
- Collaborated with product SMEs, technology teams, and testing teams to enable API integrations, transaction flows, and scheme certifications.
- **Facilitated UAT coordination and certification readiness**, ensuring solutions met Mastercard scheme rules, compliance standards, and client-specific requirements.

Implementations Analyst at Thredd

Art Technologies & Software | January 2019 - July 2022

- Worked for the Fintech's Implementations team performing phenomenally well in customer Implementation projects handling End-to-End Implementations of card-payments (Issuing) programs.
- Led end-to-end customer projects, managing scope, implementation plans, timelines, and multi-stakeholder coordination. Oversaw documentation, RAID Logs, platform configuration (Test & Production), and post-implementation support.
- Managing processor migration projects between payment scheme, Issuer, program manager, card manufacturer and multiple internal stakeholders
- Developed deep expertise in Thredd issuer processing platforms and played a key role in building the Implementations team at Art Technologies from the ground. Served as the primary contact for both internal and external stakeholders.
- Supported in formulating the UAT and SAT test cases again the issuer use case for quicker testing phase and shorter implementation TAT.
- Served as a subject matter expert in card operations, strengthening team understanding of day-to-day processes and enhancing domain capability across the card payments lifecycle.
- Drove continuous improvement, reducing change request TAT from 24 hours to 10 hours optimizing platform, domain, and team processes.

CONTACT



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GANESH NARAYANAN

TEAM LEAD, PAYMENTS

ACADEMIC BACKGROUND

Post Graduate Program in Lean Six Sigma
University of Massachusetts Amherst & KPMG (2021)
Institute of Cost & Management Accounts
Pursuing - Cost & Management Accounts
University of Calicut
Bachelor of commerce in Computer application (2011 - 14)

SKILLS

Lean six sigma & Agile Project Management
Client Relationship Management
Third-Party Management\Vendor Coordination
Project Risk Identification and Mitigation
Product Configurations and UAT Testing
Stakeholder Collaboration
Client Workshops & Training
Project performance Monitoring

CERTIFICATIONS

- Lean Management
- PMI Agile Certification
- Six Sigma Green Belt
- Six Sigma Black Belt

Senior Officer

Yes Bank | September 2016 - December 2018

- Worked for corporate operation and service delivery team, heavily focusing on operations for business banking clients, government and high net-worth clients.
- Increased branch productivity from 38% to 168% and managed 100% productivity consistently for 12 months. Also, helped to achieve average branch compliance score of 90%.
- Operated corporate account on behalf of clients, processing banking transaction and trade finance/forex transactions, corporate account openings adhering to KYC-AML Regulations.
- Coordinating and managing deliverables with sales team, customer management, customer operations team, internal higher management and internal partners.
- Delivered excellent client support and built profitable client relationships, which resulted in gaining new clients as well as 60% increment in business volumes.
- Additionally responsible for branch audit risk & compliance, and customer experience.

Junior Accountant

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